

26 Communication and beliefs

26.1 USEFUL EXPRESSIONS

Jenna **told a white lie** and said she liked Barry's new suit.

to tell a white lie

[to say something that is not true to avoid upsetting someone]



Tara is **dropping a hint** that she would like new shoes for her birthday.

to drop a hint

[to say something indirectly]



Farah **started a rumor** that Kerry stole a car.

to start / spread a rumor (US)
to start / spread a rumour (UK)

[to say things that may not be true]



Martin loves to **gossip** about other people's relationships.

to gossip

[to talk about other people, often in a negative way]



We **have a sneaking suspicion** that Tim won't come to the party with us.

to have a sneaking suspicion

[to have an idea about something with little evidence]



Do you really **believe in** ghosts?

to believe in something

[to think that something exists or is true]



I have never lost my keys.
Knock on wood!

to knock on wood (US)
to touch wood (UK)

[to wish for good luck, or avoid bad luck]



Make a wish when you cut your birthday cake!

to make a wish

[to hope for something to happen]



I **have serious misgivings** about accepting this job offer.

to have serious misgivings / doubts

[to have a strong feeling that something is not right]



You shouldn't be a **tattletale** at school.

a tattletale (US) / telltale (UK)

[somebody who tells an authority figure when another person has done something wrong]

